

Label” used in most of the European Union. The label used in Germany is called the “Blue Angel”. However not all labels are officially verified. Since there is no accepted definition for this concept, the International Organization for Standardization considers many of the labels to be too vague to be meaningful.

## Green Washing

A majority of customers are positively affected by the application of the eco friendly label to products. Companies sometimes take undue advantage of this fact by labeling their products “eco-friendly” or “environment-friendly” when they are in fact, not so. Called green washing, this tactic is perpetuated by marketing campaigns aimed to help increase the sales of the company by targeting the ecologically conscious buyers. To avoid purchasing such green washed products, one should look for products approved by groups like the Energy Star program or consumer advocacy groups like the Green Good Housekeeping Seal.

## The Good Samaritans

Not all companies have such deplorable records in terms of the environmental impact that they cause. There have been some companies over the years that have gone out of the way to incorporate sustainability and environment friendly practices into their culture even when the laws did not demand it. Now there are quite a few such companies but we will keep ourselves limited to the following companies for the purpose of illustration.

HP provides a large number of environmentally responsible recycling solutions in over 45 countries, regions and territories. It was among the first companies to begin electronic recycling back in 1987 and launched HP Planet Partners for return and reuse of laser cartridges in 1991 which continues to this date. Recycling of inkjet print cartridges was added in 1997. HP has recycled close to one billion pounds of hardware and print cartridges globally with an aggressive goal to reach two billion pounds soon.

HP Planet Partners enables the return and subsequent recycling of HP ink cartridges and laser jet supplies, any brand of computer hardware and rechargeable batteries. The returned products are

